> Successful guerrilla operations involve the people. It is the quality of their resistance to the enemy and support for the guerrillas which in the end will be the decisive factor . . . In fact, a guerrilla force will be unable to operate in an area where the people are hostile to its aims (Bermsan, 2011).

If drone attacks were garnering public sympathy for the insurgents or generating public hatred against the counter-insurgents, it could not be declared an effective tool to counter militants and terrorists.

Unlike the antagonists of the drone campaign, some were of the view that drones at least killed the terrorists, including Baitullah Mehsud, Hakimullah Mehsud, Qari Hussain and Umar Naray, who could not be handled by the Pakistan security forces. The US diplomats in Pakistan also picked up this line to defend the drone campaign in public encounters. The US Consul General at Lahore while addressing a gathering of government officers replied to a question that not all people were against drone attacks as these attacks were targeting the terrorists who were attacking the security forces of Pakistan and the public as well. Some in Pakistan viewed this from a different angle. Shahi Syed, a leader of the ANP, stated in a TV talk show that if drone attacks were violating the sovereignty of Pakistan, so were the foreign fighters like Uzbeks, Chechens and Arabs based at FATA (Waqt News TV 2012).

The negative reaction from the public was not entirely due to killing of militants. The general perception of the violation of Pakistan's sovereignty and the collateral damage were the main reasons that caused negative reactions. Why could these causes not be addressed? Pakistan's denial of granting permission to the US to carry out drone attacks and issuance of condemnatory statements after every drone killing made this campaign look like an attack on Pakistan and its sovereignty.

The US drone campaign briefly stopped after Pakistan reacted sharply to the NATO attack on two Pakistani checkposts at Salala on 26 November 2011, in which 26 soldiers were killed. In reaction, Pakistan stopped supplies to NATO and asked the US to vacate the Shamsi Airfield (Jacobabad). The Pak-US relations dipped to the lowest, and Pakistan needed an apology by the US. CIA halted the drone campaign for a while probably because it wanted to avoid further deterioration in the relationship.